

General Knowledge

Static GK

STUDY NOTES

First in India



FIRST IN INDIA



LIST OF FIRST IN INDIA

Politics and Governance

- First President of India: Dr. Rajendra Prasad (1950)
- First Vice-President of India: Dr. Sarvepalli Radhakrishnan (1952)
- First Prime Minister of India: Jawaharlal Nehru (1947)
- First Governor-General of Independent India: Lord Mountbatten (1947)
- First Indian Governor-General of India: C. Rajagopalachari (1948)
- First Chief Justice of India: H.J. Kania (1950)
- First Chief Election Commissioner: Sukumar Sen (1950)
- First Indian to become the Governor of RBI: C.D. Deshmukh (1943)
- First Indian Member of Parliament to make a speech in Hindi at the UN: Atal Bihari Vajpayee (1977)
- First Indian to be appointed as Deputy Prime Minister: Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel (1947)
- First Indian to join the Indian Civil Services: Satyendranath Tagore (1863)

First Female

IN POLITICS AND GOVERNANCE

First woman Governor of an Indian state: **Sarojini Naidu** (Uttar Pradesh, 1947)

The first woman to contest the Presidential election: **Lakshmi Sahgal** (2002)

First woman Prime Minister of India: **Indira Gandhi** (1966)

First woman Speaker of Lok Sabha: **Meira Kumar** (2009)

First woman President of India: **Pratibha Patil** (2007)

First woman judge of the Supreme Court of India: **Fathima Beevi** (1989)

First woman Chief Minister of a state: **Sucheta Kriplani** (Uttar Pradesh, 1963)

First Indian woman ambassador in a foreign country: **C.B. Muthamma** (1966, Hungary)

The first woman to become the Chief Justice of a High Court: **Leila Seth** (Himachal Pradesh, 1991)

Behind every successful woman is a tribe of other successful women who have her back.



Science and Technology

- First Indian satellite: Aryabhata (1975)
- First Indian to go to space: Rakesh Sharma (1984)
- First Indian satellite to orbit Mars: Mangalyaan (2013)
- First Indian Nobel laureate: Rabindranath Tagore (1913, Literature)
- First nuclear test in India: Pokhran-I (1974)
- First Indian to win the Nobel Prize in Physics: C.V. Raman (1930)
- First Indian to get a PhD in Science: Dr. Jagadish Chandra Bose (1896)
- The first cloned animal in India: Samrupa (2009, a buffalo calf)
- First Indigenous aircraft developed in India: HAL HF-24 Marut (1961)
- First space satellite launched from Indian soil: Rohini (1980)
- First Indian-built nuclear submarine: INS Arihant (2016)
- First Indian spacecraft to leave Earth's orbit: Chandrayaan-1 (2008)
- First Indian satellite launched by a foreign country: Aryabhata (launched by the Soviet Union, in 1975)
- First Indian woman to go to Antarctica: Meher Moos (1976)
- First Indian to reach the South Pole: Col. J.K. Bajaj (1989)
- First Indian Geostationary Satellite: APPLE (1981)
- First Indian cryogenic engine tested: GSLV-D5 (2014)
- First Indian manned mission to space planned: Gaganyaan (2024)

Sports

- First Indian to win an Olympic medal: Norman Pritchard (1900, Athletics)
- First individual Olympic gold medalist: Abhinav Bindra (Shooting, 2008)
- First Indian woman to win an Olympic medal: Karnam Malleswari (Weightlifting, 2000)
- First Indian to win a Grand Slam title: Mahesh Bhupathi (French Open, 1997, Doubles)

- First Indian woman to win a Grand Slam title: Sania Mirza (Australian Open, 2009, Mixed Doubles)
- First Indian to win a world championship in Badminton: P.V. Sindhu (2019)
- First Indian to score a century in Test cricket: Lala Amarnath (1933)
- First Indian to win an Olympic silver medal: Rajyavardhan Singh Rathore (Shooting, 2004)
- First Indian to win a gold medal at Asian Games: Sachin Nag (1951, Swimming)
- First Indian Formula One driver: Narain Karthikeyan (2005)
- First Indian woman to win a Commonwealth Games gold medal: Roopa Unnikrishnan
- First Indian woman to win an Olympic silver medal: P.V. Sindhu (Badminton, 2016)
- First Indian to win a chess World Championship: Viswanathan Anand (2000)
- First Indian to win an Asiad gold medal in athletics: Kamaljeet Sandhu (400m, 1970)
- First Indian woman to win a gold medal at the Asian Games: Kamaljeet Sandhu (Athletics, 1970)
- First Indian cricketer to score a double century in Test cricket: Polly Umrigar (1955)
- First Indian woman boxer to win a gold medal at the Asian Games: Mary Kom (2014)
- First Indian gymnast to qualify for the Olympics: Dipa Karmakar (2016)
- First Indian cricketer to take a hat-trick in Test cricket: Harbhajan Singh (2001)
- First Indian badminton player to become World No. 1: Saina Nehwal (2015)

Arts, Culture, and Literature

- First Indian to win a Nobel Prize in Literature: Rabindranath Tagore (1913)
- First Indian woman to win the Booker Prize: Arundhati Roy (1997, The God of Small Things)
- First Indian to win an Oscar: Bhanu Athaiya (1983, Best Costume Design for Gandhi)
- First Indian sound film: Alam Ara (1931)

- The first Indian film to be sent to the Oscars: Mother India (1957)
- First Indian woman to win the Miss World title: Reita Faria (1966)
- First Indian to compose the National Anthem: Rabindranath Tagore
- First Indian film to win the Palme d'Or at Cannes: Neecha Nagar (1946)
- First Indian novelist in English: Bankim Chandra Chatterjee (wrote Rajmohan's Wife in 1864)
- First Indian to win the Man Booker International Prize: Geetanjali Shree (2022, Tomb of Sand)
- First Indian to win the Ramon Magsaysay Award: Vinoba Bhave (1958)
- First Indian to win a Grammy Award: Pandit Ravi Shankar (1968)
- First Indian to win an Academy Award (Oscar): Bhanu Athaiya (Best Costume Design, 1983, Gandhi)
- First Indian writer to win the Jnanpith Award: G. Sankara Kurup (1965)
- The first Indian to direct a film in Hollywood: Ismail Merchant (In Custody, 1993)
- First Indian woman to win a Booker Prize: Arundhati Roy (1997, The God of Small Things)
- First Indian to be featured on a postage stamp: Mahatma Gandhi (1948)
- First Indian musician to perform at the United Nations: Lata Mangeshkar (1974)
- The first Indian filmmaker to win the Golden Bear Award at the Berlin Film Festival: Satyajit Ray (1964, The Big City)

Military and Defense

- First Indian Field Marshal: Sam Manekshaw (1973)
- First Indian Chief of Army Staff: General K. M. Cariappa (1949)
- The first recipient of Param Vir Chakra: was Major Somnath Sharma (1947, posthumously)
- First aircraft carrier of India: INS Vikrant (1961)
- First Indian woman in the Air Force to fly solo: Avani Chaturvedi (2018)
- First Indian nuclear submarine: INS Arihant (2016)
- First Indian Chief of Naval Staff: Vice Admiral R. D. Katari (1958)

- First Indian to receive the Victoria Cross: Khudadad Khan (1914, World War I)
- First successful missile of India: Prithvi (1988)
- First Indian aircraft carrier: INS Vikrant (1961)
- First Indian woman to join the Indian Army as an officer: Priya Jhingan (1992)
- First Indian woman to serve in a combat role in the Indian Air Force: Gunjan Saxena (1999, Kargil War)
- First Indian defense satellite: GSAT-7 (2013)
- First Indian defence exercise: Operation Vijay (1961, Goa Liberation)
- First Indian to head the United Nations Military Observer Group: Lt. Gen. Iqbal Singh Singha (2012)
- The first Indian to receive the Victoria Cross: Naik Darwan Singh Negi (1914, British Indian Army)

Economy and Business

- First Governor of Reserve Bank of India: Sir Osborne Smith (1935)
- First Indian Governor of the Reserve Bank of India: C.D. Deshmukh (1943)
- First Indian to head the International Monetary Fund (IMF): Gita Gopinath (Chief Economist, 2019)
- First bank established in India: Bank of Hindustan (1770)
- First stock exchange in India: Bombay Stock Exchange (BSE, 1875)
- First woman CEO of a bank in India: Arundhati Bhattacharya (State Bank of India, 2013)
- First Indian company to list on the New York Stock Exchange (NYSE): Infosys (1999)
- First Indian billionaire: Dhirubhai Ambani (1980s)
- First Indian company to cross \$100 billion in market capitalization: Tata Consultancy Services (2018)
- First Indian company listed on the NYSE: Infosys (1999)
- First Indian private sector bank: IndusInd Bank (1994)

- The first woman to head the Indian Banks' Association: Usha Ananthasubramanian (2017)
- First Indian company to reach \$100 billion in market value: Reliance Industries (2019)
- First Indian e-commerce company: Rediff.com (1996)
- First Indian woman to chair a public sector bank: Arundhati Bhattacharya (State Bank of India, 2013)
- First Indian company to cross \$1 trillion in market capitalization: Reliance Industries (2020)
- First Indian start-up to become a unicorn: InMobi (2011)

The first Female in India

First female in India	Names	Year
First female doctor in India	Anandi Gopal Joshi	1887
First female teacher in India	Savitribai Phule	1848
India's first women I.P.S officer	Kiran Bedi	1972
First woman auto-rickshaw driver	Shila Dawre	1988
First female pilot in India	Sarla Thakral	1936
First female train driver in India	Surekha Yadav	1988
First female Rafale pilot in India	Flight Lieutenant Shivangi Singh	2017
First female army officer in India	Captain Lakshmi Sehgal	1943
First female astronaut in India	Kalpana Chawla	2003
First female prime minister in India	Indira Gandhi	1966- 1977

First female engineer in India	Lalitha Ayyalasomayajula	1919- 1979
First female lawyer in India	Cornelia Sorabji	1894
First female president in India	Pratibha Patil	2007 - 2012
First female chief minister in India	Sucheta Kripalani	1963
First female actress in India	Durgabai Kamat	1914
First female barrister in India	Cornelia Sorabji	1866- 1954
First female fighter pilot in India	Bhawana Kanth	2016
First female neurosurgeon in India	Thanjavur Santhanakrishnan Kanaka	1932- 2018
First female airline pilot in India	Durba Banerjee	1959
First female governor in India	Sarojini Naidu	1947- 1949
First female scientist in India	Kamala Sohonie	1912- 1988
First female IFS officer in India	Chonira Belliappa Muthamma	1949
First female mining engineer in India	Dr. Chandrani Prasad Verma	1999
First CM female in India	Sucheta Kripalani	1908- 1974
First educated female in India	Savitribai Phule	1831- 1897
First female defense minister in India	Nirmala Sitharaman	2017
First female entrepreneurs in India	Kalpana Saroj	2001

First female dentist in India	Vimal Sood	1922- 2021
First woman president of INC	Annie Besant	1917
First woman union minister	Rajkumari Amrita Kaur	1947
India's first woman ruler (on Delhi's throne)	Razia Sultan	1236 to 1240
First woman to get Ashok Chakra	Nirja Bhanot	1987
First Indian woman to get the Nobel prize	Mother Teresa	1979
First Indian woman to climb Mt. Everest	Bachendri Pal	1984
First Indian woman to become Miss World	Miss Reita Faria	1966
First woman to get the Jnanpith award	Ashpurna Devi	1976
First Indian woman to win a gold in Asian games	Kamaljeet Sandhu	1970
First Indian woman to win the Booker prize	Arundhati Roy	1992
First woman musician to get Bharat Ratna	Ms Subbulakshmi	1916- 2004
First Indian woman to win WTA title	Sania Mirza	2005

Miscellaneous Firsts

- First metro rail in India: Kolkata Metro (1984)
- The first newspaper in India: Hicky's Bengal Gazette (1780)
- First dam in India: Kallanai Dam (also known as Grand Anicut, built in Tamil Nadu in the 2nd century AD)
- First Indian state to achieve 100% literacy: Kerala (1991)
- First IIT (Indian Institute of Technology): IIT Kharagpur (1951)

- First national park in India: Jim Corbett National Park (1936, originally named Hailey National Park)
- First post office in India: Kolkata (1727)
- The first state in India formed on a linguistic basis: Andhra Pradesh (1953)
- First floating post office: Dal Lake, Srinagar (2011)
- The first person to get a pilot license in India: J.R.D. Tata (1929)
- First zoo in India: Alipore Zoological Gardens, Kolkata (1876)
- First hydroelectric power plant in India: Shivanasamudra, Karnataka (1902)
- First solar power project in India: Charanka Solar Park, Gujarat (2012)
- First expressway in India: Mumbai-Pune Expressway (2002)
- The first international airport in India: Cochin International Airport (first solar-powered, 2015)
- The first newspaper published in India: Hicky's Bengal Gazette (1780)
- First robot-assisted surgery in India: AIIMS, New Delhi (2006)
- First eco-tourism project in India: Thenmala, Kerala (1999)
- First theme park in India: Appu Ghar, Delhi (1984)
- First biosphere reserve in India: Nilgiri Biosphere Reserve (1986)